JIANG NAN 江南	**Storage Hierarchy Policy**	Document No.:	IKQAP#011
		Revision No.	2
	Imperial Kitchen Group Inc.,	Effective Date:	June 29, 2026

1. Purpose

This policy aims to establish a systematic storage hierarchy for all physical goods, ingredients, and materials within Imperial Kitchen Group Corp. properties. By categorizing items based on turnover rates, environmental requirements, and safety protocols. We ensure optimal operational efficiency, minimize waste through standardized organization, and maintain high safety standards in our storage facilities.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all departments involved in the handling, storage, and retrieval of inventory, including warehouse personnel, kitchen staff, and administrative teams. It covers all storage environments, including dry storage, cold chain facilities (chillers/freezers), and chemical storage zones across all company-owned and operated premises.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Restaurant/ Shift / Warehouse Manager

Shall be responsible for auditing and documentation, which requires conducting and using the Weekly Storage Audit Checklist to systematically verify shelf labeling, FIFO/FEFO compliance, and height-load safety. Throughout this process, personnel must document all instances of non-compliance to ensure transparency and track necessary corrective actions.

3.2. Warehouse and Kitchen Employees

Shall be responsible for daily inventory handling, 5S upkeep, storage, and retrieval of items across all environments, including dry storage, cold chain facilities, and chemical storage zones. To ensure proper stock rotation, personnel must physically reorganize stock in strict compliance with FIFO (First-In, First-Out) and FEFO (First Expired, First Out) protocols by placing the oldest or earliest-expiring items at the front , which includes executing daily sorting so that any expired or damaged goods are promptly logged and removed from the storage facility.

3.3. Quality Assurance (QA)

Shall established the framework aligning physical storage placement with item velocity and safety rules. Administratively, the QA Specialists are responsible for preparing the policy document. In terms of oversight, personnel executing the weekly audits must use the audit checklist to verify labeling, FIFO/FEFO compliance, and height-load safety, while documenting any violations. Finally, they must ensure that all identified corrective actions are completed and signed off within 24 hours of discovery.

4. Policy Guidelines (5S Storage Framework)

All branch kitchen areas must strictly enforce the five pillars of 5S on every shift:

4.1. Sort (Seiri)

Only active inventory, authorized utensils, and sanitized food-grade storage containers are permitted within food prep and storage zones.

- ***Implementation****:* Every day empty cardboard boxes, unauthorized materials, and damaged utensils are removed from the storage and kitchen area. Non-essential objects should never clutter space for storage.

4.2. Set in Order (Seiton)

“A place for everything, and everything in its place." All food items and kitchen tools must have designated zones.

- ***Implementation****:* Refrigerator doors must be clearly labeled to specify their designation (e.g., **"GRILL"**). Inside the units, containers must be neatly aligned, rows must be squared off, and stacks must be uniform to allow easy visibility and access.

4.3. Shine (Seiso)

Continuous cleanliness must be maintained throughout the shift. All workspaces, storage racks, and refrigeration interiors must be kept immaculately clean.

- ***Implementation****:* Exterior stainless steel surfaces, refrigerator gaskets, handles, and internal wire shelving must be kept free from grease, residue, or ice build-up. Any spills inside cooling units must be wiped down immediately to maintain a sanitary holding environment.

4.4. Standardize (Seiketsu)

Visual tools, labeling patterns, and container types must be uniform across all stations and branches.

- ***Implementation****:* Standardized clear lidded boxes must be used for prepped ingredients, and standardized color-coded plastic bins must be utilized for service line stock. Every single container must feature a standardized printed white label facing outwards.

4.5. Sustain (Shitsuke)

Keeping the kitchen organized must become a daily habit.

- ***Implementation****:* Restaurant or shift managers must conduct a 10-minute nightly walkthrough. This ensures the entire facility is orderly and that all equipment, tools, and products are returned to their designated areas.

5. Storage Hierarchy Standard

To ensure maximum food safety, systematic airflow, and seamless operational flow, all goods must be stored according to the following guidelines:

5.1. Vertical Storage Hierarchy (Upright Multi-Door Chillers & Refrigerators)

To prevent any possibility of cross-contamination, products inside upright refrigeration units must be systematically layered from top to bottom based on processing status and hazard levels:

- **Top Shelves (Ready-to-Eat / Prepared Items):** House cooked broths, dipping sauce blends, condiments, and pre-portioned cooked side items. All items must be kept in clear, tightly sealed, lidded plastic containers.
- **Middle Shelves (Fresh Produce & Leafy Greens):** Reserved for washed and portioned vegetables. To guarantee proper air circulation and prevent moisture damage, vegetables must be organized into uniform, perforated plastic baskets.
- **Lower Shelves / Specific Dedicated Units (Raw Proteins):** Raw sliced meats, hotpot meatballs, and raw seafood must be isolated to lower shelves or entirely designated units (such as specific "GRILL" freezer units). Raw proteins must never be placed on shelves above cooked items or raw vegetables.

5.2. Hotpot Main Service Line & Prep Stations (Top Service Counter Layer)

Immediate-use items must be kept in stainless steel gastronorm pans neatly inset into the chilled prep line. During off-peak operational windows, pans must be securely covered with pristine plastic wrap or lids to retain freshness.

- **Under-Counter Backup Chillers:** The refrigeration compartments directly below the service counter must hold exact backup replacements packed in clear, labeled lidded bins. This enables immediate replenishment during high-volume service hours without requiring staff to leave the line.

5.3. Dry Goods Storage Racking Systems (Racking Infrastructure)

Dry inventory, packaging, and non-perishables must be stored exclusively on industrial, multi-tier heavy-duty steel shelves:

- **Floor Clearance Rule:** Absolutely no item, box, or bulk container is allowed to sit directly on the floor. The lowest shelf layer must provide a minimum clearance of 6 inches from the ground to prevent moisture or pest issues.
- **Weight Distribution:** Heavy bulk items, boxed shipments, and large containers of cooking oils must reside on the lowest shelf levels. Lighter dry goods, packaging boxes, takeaway items, and clean uniform bundles must be assigned to the middle and upper tiers.

5.4. Chemical Storage

To eliminate any risk of accidental chemical contamination in food products, packaging, or utensils, the following vertical and spatial hierarchies must be strictly enforced:

- **Absolute Isolation Rule:** Chemicals (including dishwashing liquid, degreasers, sanitizers, floor cleaners, and pest control sprays) must **NEVER** be stored in the same room, rack, or cabinet as food items, food contact utensils, or single-use packaging (takeaway boxes, cups).
- **Dedicated Chemical Station:** Every branch must designate a specific, locked cabinet or isolated shelving unit clearly marked: **"CHEMICAL STORAGE ONLY"**.
- **Under-Sink/Floor Level Storage:** If chemicals are kept near a dishwashing or cleaning sink, they must be placed **exclusively on the lowest shelf** or floor-level drip trays.
- They must **NEVER** be placed on top shelves where they could leak, drip, or spill downward onto clean plates, utensils, or food prep counters.

6. Visual Control & Container Standards

6.1. Color-Coding Rules

- **Serving Bins:** Food trays and customer-facing ingredient bins must be grouped by item category using standardized red, yellow, orange, green and brown color-coded stacking containers to manage portions and item separation effortlessly.
- **Produce Baskets:** Perforated plastic baskets are strictly designated for vegetable cold holding to maintain visual consistency across all branches

6.2. Mandatory Labeling Requirements

Every non-original package, decanted item, or prepped ingredient container must feature a printed adhesive white label positioned to face outward toward the user.

- Handwritten markings directly onto plastic container surfaces are prohibited. Labels must explicitly specify: Item Description, Prep/Opening Date, Expiration Date, and Initials of the employee responsible.

6.3. FIFO Rotation System (First-In, First-Out)

Newly prepped batches or freshly received shipments must always be positioned *behind* or *underneath* existing inventory.

- Kitchen employees must pull items from the front of rows or the top of stacks to guarantee that older stock is exhausted first and prevent product expiration.

7. Corrective Action

All system gaps or rule breaches require resolution and official sign-off within 24 hours of discovery.

Non-Compliance Issue	Immediate Corrective Action	Target Timeline	Responsible Party
Miszoned Stock	Transfer items to designated areas.	Within 24 hours	Warehouse / Kitchen Employees
Expired/Damaged Stock	Immediately log in the Disposal Log and discard entirely from the facility.	Immediate	Warehouse / Kitchen Employees
Missing / Defaced Labels	Print/Handwritten and apply standardized labels detailing Item Name, PD/ED, Quantity and Employee's Initial	Within 24 hours	Warehouse / Kitchen Employees
Chemical Misalignment	Remove the chemical from its current location, place it in a designated area to prevent accidental use or reaction.	Immediate	Warehouse / Kitchen Employees
Cold Chain Temp Breach	Notify the Shift Manager; transfer vulnerable stock to operational units if limits are compromised.	Immediate	Shift Manager / Employees

8. List of Documents

- Equipment Temperature Monitoring
- Inventory Bin Card
- Daily Sanitation and Cleaning Log
- Inventory Scrap & Disposal Log

9. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	April 28, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist**	Originator
1	June 15, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist**	• Revise the policy guidelines, corrective action and list of documents
2	June 16, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez**, QA Specialist**	• Added the implementation for 5S Storage Framework

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